

SHRUTHI SANKARANARAYANAN

Höhrerstraße 48, 56179 Vallendar, Germany | +49 155 60416431 | shruthishankar1604@gmail.com

Henkel
Düsseldorf Office

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Application for Internship New Business Development - LOCTITE Pulse – starting from May 1st, 2025

Dear Recruiting Team,

I am currently in the first semester of my Master's in International Business at WHU – Otto Beisheim School of Management. I would like to apply for the Internship New Business Development - LOCTITE Pulse at Henkel. I am available from May through August 2025.

During my studies at WHU, I had the opportunity to attend a guest lecture by Katharina Roscher, Corporate Director of Brand Tech & Ecosystems at Henkel. She shared detailed insights into the strategies and rebranding process of the Schwarzkopf website. This sparked my interest in how strategic frameworks and business developments can occur in an impressive global FMCG company. I am drawn to this opportunity to learn directly from seasoned professionals and gain insights into what strategies go into sales and marketing in such large organizations.

My WHU course in International Strategy provided an in-depth understanding of various business models and strategic frameworks. This course sparked an interest in the strategies that drive success or failure in major organizations, such as Coca-Cola, Boeing, and Hindalco. As I delved deeper into case studies, I became fascinated by how strategic choices can shape an organization's future, impact its competitive positioning, and ultimately determine its success. This structured, forward-thinking approach, where every decision considers multiple potential outcomes, appeals to me and motivates me to further explore the field of strategy. I received top marks for the course (1.0) and was commended for my insights, reflecting my analytical and structured approach to problem-solving. This academic experience, combined with my professional background, has given me a unique perspective on addressing business challenges within a strategic context.

In my previous role as Sales Team Lead at Pickyourtrail, I gained valuable experience in planning and coordinating tasks across a team. My different responsibilities taught me the importance of considering each team member while adopting a team-wide strategy that kept everyone aligned and motivated. Each month, I reviewed performance data and client conversion metrics to highlight which destinations were driving the best results. This analysis helped me focus our efforts on high-potential destinations and adapt our sales pitches to match client preferences and seasonal demand. By guiding my team in these efforts, I learned how strategic insights can be practically applied to achieve measurable goals—a skill I am eager to develop further in this consulting role. I also worked closely with team members who needed extra support, looking into their performance metrics to identify improvement areas and addressing any other factors that might impact their motivation. This experience taught me the value of combining strategy with practical team management.

In my role at Pickyourtrail, I also developed innovative client acquisition strategies, targeting high-potential markets identified through market analysis of top selling destinations experiencing heavy tourism. This experience sharpened my ability to analyze market opportunities and devise actionable strategies to drive business growth.

Henkel's Internship offers an exceptional opportunity to acquire the practical skills required to excel in sales and marketing development—an experience no classroom can replicate. I am confident that my curiosity, commitment to learning, and persistence in facing challenges will help me excel in this internship and make a meaningful contribution.

Thank you very much for considering my application. I am excited about the opportunity to learn from the team at Henkel, and I look forward to discussing my fit for the program in further detail.

Sincerely,
Shruthi Sankaranarayanan